

CLASS OBSERVATION WORKSHEET FOR EDUC 1 – THE TEACHING PROFESSION

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Observer's Name: Kenn Arcenal

Date of Observation: August 18, 2026

Grade Level / Subject: Grade 9 - English

Name of Professor/Teacher Observed: Mr. Vic Magara

I. General Observations

1. Describe both the physical and *psychological* classroom environment.

The class was held in a typical private secondary classroom (spacious, well-ventilated, well-lit, well-maintained) and arranged to make group work easy. Basic technology expected in private schools such as projector and speakers were available and used for presentation, and there enough room for the teacher to move around and reach every cluster during class activities.

In terms of the psychological classroom environment, the atmosphere felt safe and encouraging rather than tense. Students appeared comfortable enough to answer, show emotions, share opinions, which suggested a good rapport between them and their teacher. Since the poem being studied (i.e., *Invictus*) deals with hardship and resilience, the mood carried a quiet seriousness as well, and the teacher handled that sensitively so that students could relate the material to their own lives without feeling exposed or pressured.

2. What teaching methods or strategies did the teacher use? Why did you say so?

(e.g., direct instruction/lecture, group work, flipped classroom)

The teacher used a blend of strategies, but the dominant ones were collaborative group work and guided discussion rather than lecture or direct instruction. After a brief introduction to *Invictus*, the class was divided into four groups, each assigned a stanza to read and analyze, and then represent through a creative and symbolic illustration. The bulk of the period was spent on students working together and then presenting, while the teacher moved from group to group giving feedback and asking follow-up questions. The lesson also included a short informal debate on whether people truly control their own fate, and an individual written reflection connecting the poem's closing lines to the students' own struggles. Direct instruction was present as well but mostly supplementary, used to clarify literary devices.

II. Teaching Philosophy in Practice

3. Which teaching philosophy (or philosophies) best describe/s the “observed class” as manifested by the teacher? Why?

The observed class was best-described by progressivism, with clear touches of existentialism. It was progressivist in a way that learning was active, student-centered, and experiential, as the teacher functioned more as a facilitator who guided discovery than as a lecturer delivering finished answers. Students built understanding through collaboration, illustration, discussion, self-reflection, and debate, which reflects the progressivist belief that learners understand best by doing and by connecting lessons to their own experiences. The existentialist element showed in how the teacher pushed the students beyond the text toward real life, first through a debate on how much control people have over their circumstances, and then through a reflection asking them to apply the poem's message of resilience to their own academic and personal struggles. In doing so, literature became a mirror for examining life, values, and human condition, which goes beyond simply mastering content.

4. Give at least two (2) situations from the class that illustrate that teaching philosophy.

First, the group activity on the four stanzas of *Invictus* clearly illustrated progressivism. Instead of explaining the poem line by line, the teacher gave the students the opportunity to analyze the meaning themselves and express it through a symbolic drawing before presenting to the class. The teacher also circulated to give feedback and posed follow-up critical-thinking questions during the presentations, which kept the students in the role of active meaning-makers. Second, the informal debate and the personal reflection activities demonstrated existentialist learning. Students had to defend opposing views, which required them to weigh their own values and worldview. In addition, the closing reflection led the students to ruminate through the poem their present struggles in various areas of their lives, turning the lesson into an occasion for self-awareness and connection to the wider world.

III. Reflection

5. What aspects of the lesson did you find most effective in supporting student learning?

The most effective aspect was the well-structured group activity supported by clear expectations. Since the teacher provided learning targets in advance, presented a rubric, and kept the time, students knew exactly what was expected and how much time they had, which kept them focused and productive. The creative illustration task was also powerful, since it pushed students to interpret meaning symbolically instead of just paraphrasing, deepening their engagement with the poem. Equally effective were the process-ing after each presentation, which stretched students' reasoning, a long with the teacher's mastery of the material, clear and audible voice, and habit of moving around to give feedback during the whole activity.

6. Were there any conflicts or inconsistencies between the teacher's methods/strategies and the teaching philosophy manifested? Explain.

There were minor inconsistencies. The class was strongly progressivist and student-centered, yet at times the flow slipped back toward a more teacher-directed pattern, and there were moments when the teacher became authoritative when pointing at the students rather than calling by their names. During presentations, a few groups were still finishing their work while another group was already sharing, so not everyone was fully listening, which ran against the collaborative spirit the activity was meant to build. There was also background music during the activity that, while intended to set a mood, occasionally competed with the student's focus. None of these seriously contradicted the underlying philosophies, but they showed how demanding it is to sustain a fully student-centered classroom from start to finish.

7. What might you adapt or apply in your own teaching practice based on this observation?

I would gladly adopt several practices Mr Magara demonstrated. Giving learning objectives clearly ahead of time, presenting a clear rubric, defining timing of activities are simple habits that create structure and fairness, and I intend to make them standard in my own classes. I also value how the teacher combined collaboration, creative expression, debate, and personal reflection in a way that a literature class could come alive and develop both thinking skills, creativity, and self-awareness, and I would like to design lessons with that same range. From the small inconsistencies, I also learned to sustain a student-centered classroom that requires careful management, and that good planning is what allows genuine, active learning to happen.